
Data

27 messages

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>
To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Sat, Jan 10, 2026 at 9:27 AM

Patrick

Would you like some division of labor on preparing the data? I could make some time to work on that this evening, but I don't want to duplicate whatever you're doing.

Michael Coppedge
Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center
University of Notre Dame
Notre Dame, IN 46556
(574) 631-7036
[Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow](#)
[Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage](#)

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sat, Jan 10, 2026 at 11:59 AM

Thanks Michael. There are two pending tasks, right? (1) Revising the extraction of V-Dem data, which will now include coder-level information, and (2) Comparing your suggestion and revising the calculation of cardinal direction variables from V-Dem data. I think I can send you the revised index by the evening tonight, but in the meantime, maybe you can look at how I calculated the cardinal direction expert ratings in the attached script. -Patrick

[Quoted text hidden]

 **vdem_extract_v2.R**
12K

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>
To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Sat, Jan 10, 2026 at 12:01 PM

OK, I'll look at that right now. I will be entertaining guests from 2:00 to 5:30.

Michael Coppedge
Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center
University of Notre Dame
Notre Dame, IN 46556
(574) 631-7036
[Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow](#)
[Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage](#)

[Quoted text hidden]

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sat, Jan 10, 2026 at 12:05 PM

No problem! I will try to update the coder-level data by then. -Patrick

[Quoted text hidden]

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sat, Jan 10, 2026 at 6:59 PM

Dear Michael, I went through the coder-level data script you shared with me, getting as far as I could (I lost your train of thought in the last quarter or so of the script). But I tried to replicate what you did for elections, applying the calculations to civil liberties, resulting in

two dfs: more_vs_less.rds (elections) and strong_vs_weak.rds (civil liberties). I then filtered out Colombia and joined them to create a combined weights dataset. The summary of variables is below, and the script and final dataset (in .rds) are attached. If it looks okay to you, I can go ahead and update the last script I sent you and then re-calculate the final index. Let me know what you think. -Patrick

```
> summary(COL_combined)
country_text_id      year      emel_Civil_unrest      emel_East      emel_Illicit_activity em
el_Indigenous      emel_Inside_capital emel_Less_development emel_Longer_foreign_rule
Length:125      Min.      :1900      Min.      :-0.84615      Min.      :-0.4000      Min.      :-0.800000      Mi
n.      : -0.5556      Min.      :0.2500      Min.      :-0.6667      Min.      :0
Class :character      1st Qu.:1931      1st Qu.: -0.40000      1st Qu.: 0.2000      1st Qu.: -0.250000      1s
t Qu.: 0.2000      1st Qu.:0.3333      1st Qu.: -0.4286      1st Qu.:0
Mode  :character      Median :1962      Median : -0.25000      Median : 0.2500      Median : 0.000000      Me
dian : 0.2500      Median :0.3333      Median : -0.4167      Median :0
      Mean      :1962      Mean      : -0.19857      Mean      : 0.2275      Mean      : -0.004329      Me
an      : 0.1934      Mean      :0.3981      Mean      : -0.4069      Mean      :0
      3rd Qu.:1993      3rd Qu.: 0.08333      3rd Qu.: 0.3333      3rd Qu.: 0.333333      3r
d Qu.: 0.3333      3rd Qu.:0.5000      3rd Qu.: -0.3529      3rd Qu.:0
      Max.      :2024      Max.      : 0.08333      Max.      : 0.3333      Max.      : 0.333333      Ma
x.      : 0.3333      Max.      :0.8000      Max.      : -0.1667      Max.      :0
      emel_More_development emel_No_foreign_rule emel_None_of_the_above      emel_North      emel_Outsid
e_capital emel_Recent_foreign_rule      emel_Remote      emel_Ruling_party_strong
Min.      :0.0000      Min.      :0.00000      Min.      :0      Min.      : -0.1111      Min.      : -0.
6000      Min.      :0      Min.      : -0.80000      Min.      : -0.2500
1st Qu.:0.0000      1st Qu.:0.00000      1st Qu.:0      1st Qu.: 0.2000      1st Qu.: 0.
0000      1st Qu.:0      1st Qu.: 0.00000      1st Qu.: -0.2500
Median :0.2500      Median :0.00000      Median :0      Median : 0.2500      Median : 0.
2500      Median :0      Median : 0.00000      Median : 0.0000
Mean      :0.2016      Mean      :0.01277      Mean      :0      Mean      : 0.2538      Mean      : 0.
1805      Mean      :0      Mean      : -0.01879      Mean      : -0.0563
3rd Qu.:0.4000      3rd Qu.:0.00000      3rd Qu.:0      3rd Qu.: 0.3333      3rd Qu.: 0.
3333      3rd Qu.:0      3rd Qu.: 0.08333      3rd Qu.: 0.0000
Max.      :0.6667      Max.      :0.20000      Max.      :0      Max.      : 0.3333      Max.      : 0.
3333      Max.      :0      Max.      : 0.33333      Max.      : 0.4000
      emel_Ruling_party_weak      emel_Rural      emel_Shorter_foreign_rule      emel_South      emel_Spar
se_population      emel_Urban      emel_West      cscw_Civil_unrest      cscw_East
Min.      : -0.20000      Min.      : -0.8000      Min.      :0      Min.      : -0.44444      Min.      : -
0.6000      Min.      :0.6000      Min.      : -0.18750      Min.      : -1.0000      Min.      : -1.0000
1st Qu.: 0.00000      1st Qu.: -0.4000      1st Qu.:0      1st Qu.: 0.00000      1st Qu.: 0.00000      1st Qu.:
0.2000      1st Qu.:0.6667      1st Qu.: 0.07143      1st Qu.: -1.0000      1st Qu.: -1.0000
Median : 0.00000      Median : -0.2500      Median :0      Median : 0.00000      Median : 0.00000      Median :
0.2500      Median :0.7500      Median : 0.25000      Median : -0.7143      Median : -1.0000
Mean      : -0.01279      Mean      : -0.3034      Mean      :0      Mean      : -0.01460      Mean      :
0.1997      Mean      :0.7552      Mean      : 0.22309      Mean      : -0.8164      Mean      : -0.8383
3rd Qu.: 0.00000      3rd Qu.: -0.1667      3rd Qu.:0      3rd Qu.: 0.08333      3rd Qu.: 0.08333      3rd Qu.:
0.3333      3rd Qu.:0.8000      3rd Qu.: 0.33333      3rd Qu.: -0.6667      3rd Qu.: -0.7500
Max.      : 0.00000      Max.      : -0.1667      Max.      :0      Max.      : 0.08333      Max.      :
0.3333      Max.      :1.0000      Max.      : 0.33333      Max.      : -0.6667      Max.      : 0.0000
      cscw_Illicit_activity cscw_Indigenous      cscw_Inside_capital cscw_Less_development cscw_Longer_f
oreign_rule cscw_More_development cscw_No_foreign_rule cscw_None_of_the_above
Min.      : -1.0000      Min.      : -0.9091      Min.      :0.0000      Min.      : -1.0000      Min.      :0
Min.      :0.2500      Min.      :0      Min.      :0.0000
1st Qu.: -1.0000      1st Qu.: -0.6667      1st Qu.:0.3333      1st Qu.: -0.6667      1st Qu.:0
1st Qu.:0.3333      1st Qu.:0      1st Qu.:0.0000
Median : -0.8333      Median : -0.6667      Median :0.3333      Median : -0.6667      Median :0
Median :0.3333      Median :0      Median :0.0000
Mean      : -0.8230      Mean      : -0.5970      Mean      :0.4285      Mean      : -0.6122      Mean      :0
Mean      :0.4533      Mean      :0      Mean      :0.0160
3rd Qu.: -0.6667      3rd Qu.: -0.5000      3rd Qu.:0.5000      3rd Qu.: -0.5000      3rd Qu.:0
3rd Qu.:0.5000      3rd Qu.:0      3rd Qu.:0.0000
Max.      : -0.6667      Max.      : -0.3333      Max.      :0.9091      Max.      : -0.3333      Max.      :0
Max.      :1.0000      Max.      :0      Max.      :0.3333
      cscw_North      cscw_Outside_capital cscw_Recent_foreign_rule      cscw_Remote      cscw_Ruling_p
arty_strong cscw_Ruling_party_weak      cscw_Rural      cscw_Shorter_foreign_rule
Min.      : -0.6667      Min.      : -1.0000      Min.      :0      Min.      : -1.0000      Min.      : -0.33
333      Min.      : -0.5000      Min.      : -1.0000      Min.      :0
1st Qu.: -0.3333      1st Qu.: -1.0000      1st Qu.:0      1st Qu.: -1.0000      1st Qu.: -0.33
```

333	1st Qu.: -0.2500	1st Qu.: -1.0000	1st Qu.: 0	Median : -1.0000	Median : 0.00
000	Median : -0.2000	Median : -1.0000	Median : 0		
Mean : -0.2996	Mean : -0.9343	Mean : 0		Mean : -0.9746	Mean : -0.06
166	Mean : -0.1465	Mean : -0.9919	Mean : 0		
3rd Qu.: -0.2500	3rd Qu.: -1.0000	3rd Qu.: 0		3rd Qu.: -1.0000	3rd Qu.: 0.00
000	3rd Qu.: 0.0000	3rd Qu.: -1.0000	3rd Qu.: 0		
Max. : 0.2222	Max. : -0.4444	Max. : 0		Max. : -0.6667	Max. : 0.55
556	Max. : 0.0000	Max. : -0.6667	Max. : 0		
cscw_South	cscw_Sparse_population	cscw_Urban	cscw_West		
Min. : -1.0000	Min. : -0.7778	Min. : 0.0000	Min. : -0.6667		
1st Qu.: -1.0000	1st Qu.: -0.5000	1st Qu.: 0.3333	1st Qu.: -0.5000		
Median : -1.0000	Median : -0.3333	Median : 0.3333	Median : -0.3333		
Mean : -0.9396	Mean : -0.4164	Mean : 0.4919	Mean : -0.3977		
3rd Qu.: -1.0000	3rd Qu.: -0.3333	3rd Qu.: 0.7500	3rd Qu.: -0.3333		
Max. : -0.5000	Max. : -0.3333	Max. : 1.0000	Max. : 0.0000		

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2 attachments

-  COL_combined.rds
47K
-  vdem_coder_extract.R
32K

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>
To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Sat, Jan 10, 2026 at 7:23 PM

It may be mostly right, but I think that the *_North, *_South, etc. products should never be zero in the plan I sent you late yesterday afternoon, because the weights are all absolute values of differences and the geographic data are all between 0 and 1.

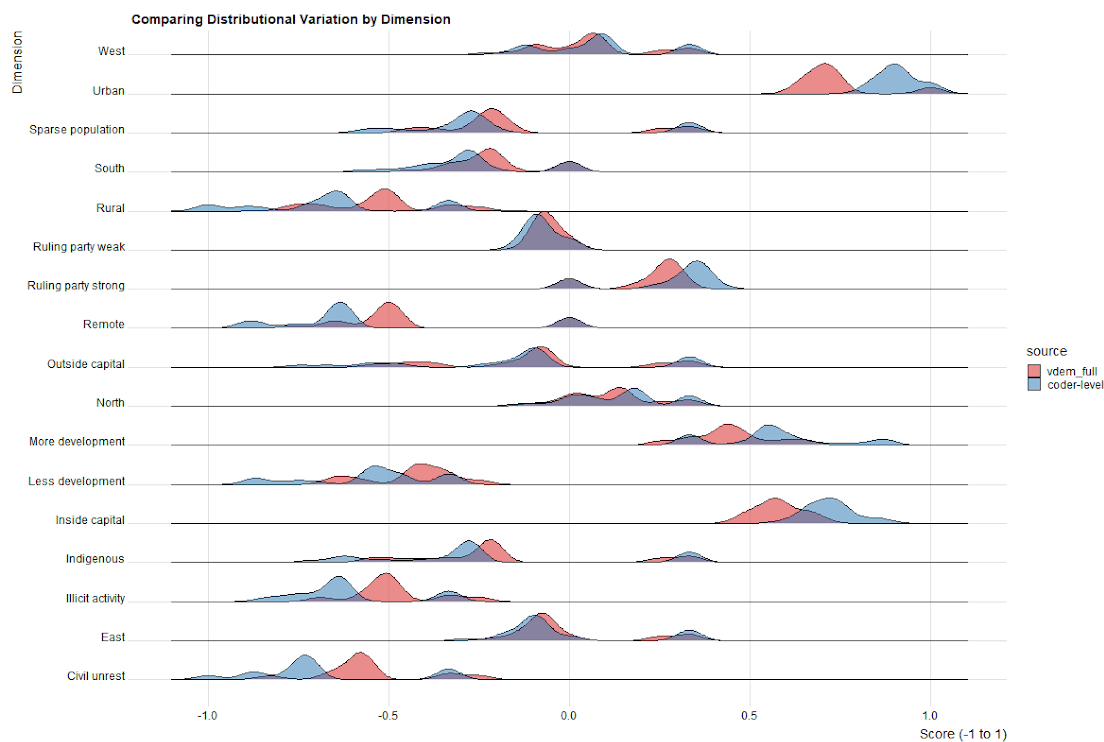
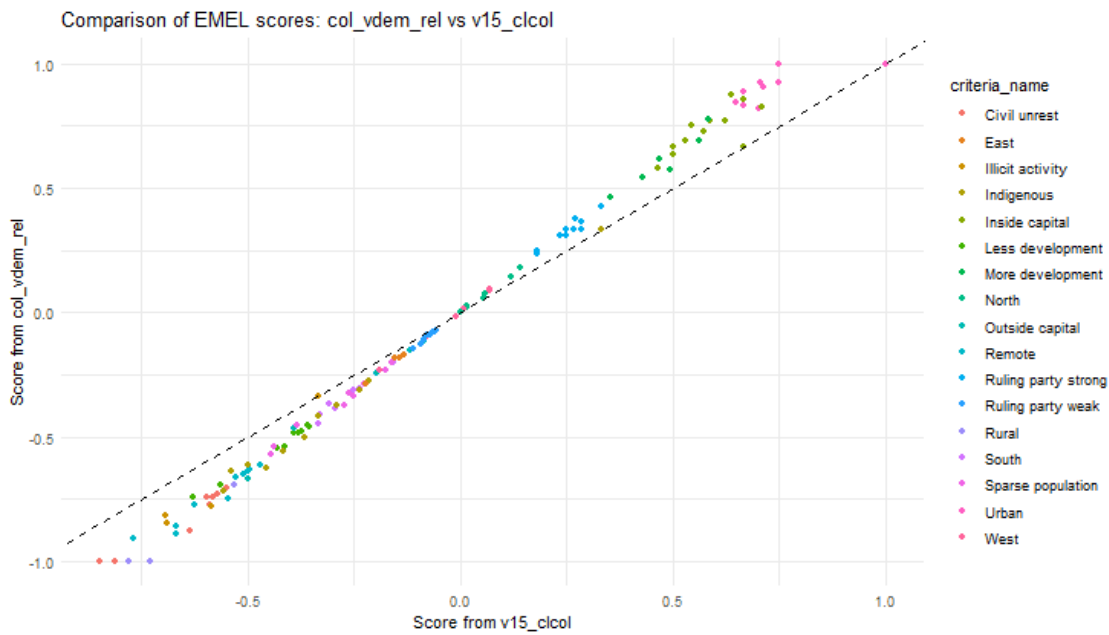
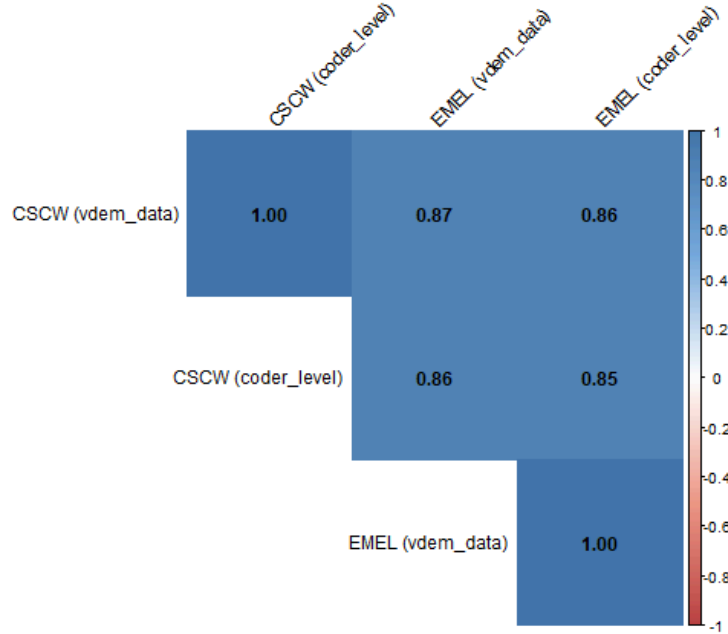
Michael Coppedge
Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center
University of Notre Dame
Notre Dame, IN 46556
(574) 631-7036
Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow
Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage

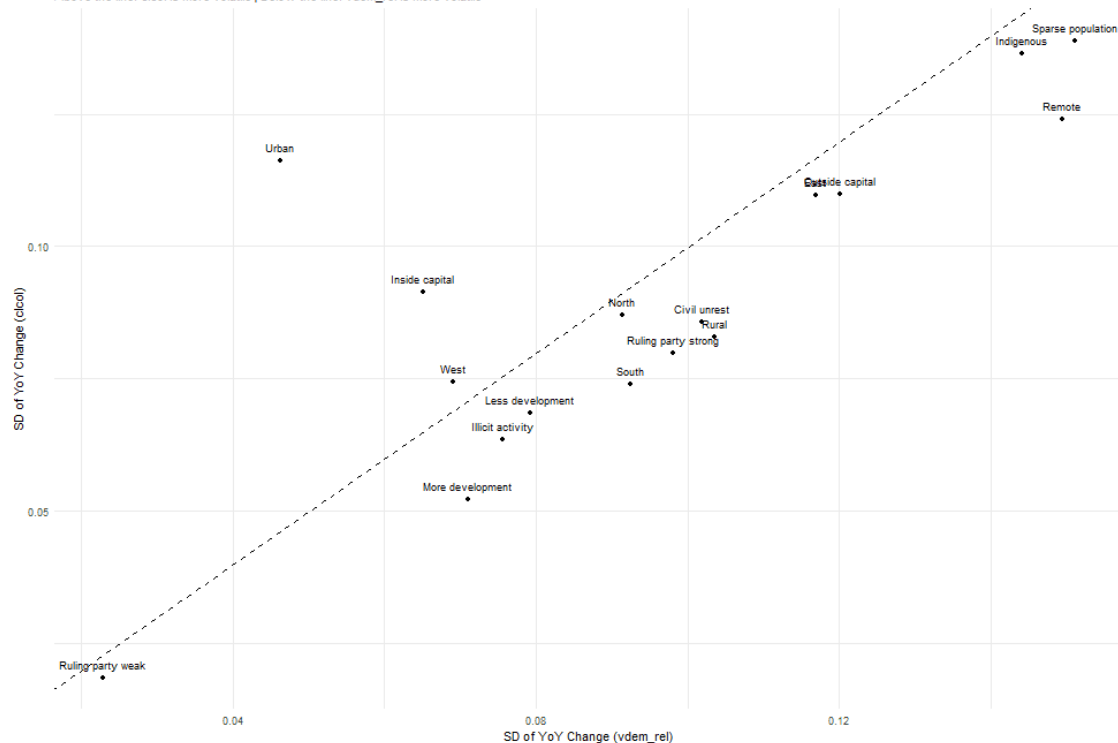
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Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sat, Jan 10, 2026 at 9:41 PM

Sorry, that last message I sent you contains only V-Dem coder-level data. It's the step before interacting with geo-located data. Before interacting with geolocated data, I just wanted to make sure that the coder-level calculations (aka: v15_clcol) were correlated to the "Country-Year: V-Dem Full" dataset that I had used for our index so far. To my relief, the two sets of data are highly correlated. Below are some statistics on their correlations (thanks, Gemini), as well as a ggridges plot showing that coder-level variation looks more distributed than the V-Dem full data (as I expected). However, V-Dem Full data has more volatility (year-over-year change) than coder-level data, for the most part. On another note, I am unsure whether or when we could include the coder-level HPD data in our analysis. Maybe that is something to include after merging with the geolocated data? -Patrick





[Quoted text hidden]

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>
To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Sat, Jan 10, 2026 at 10:22 PM

Nice plots!
I know it was just the coder-level data (i.e., what I'm calling "weights" in the text). My point is that all the weights should be positive. I don't understand why any of these are negative. In the first place, most of them should have been converted to CDFs, which range between 0 and 1. In the second place, we should be taking the absolute values of the differences between more and less or strong and weak, and absolute values are all positive by definition. So why are some of these negative?

I'm still working through your script. Sorry, my event started early and ended late.

Michael Coppedge
Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center
University of Notre Dame
Notre Dame, IN 46556
(574) 631-7036
[Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow](#)
[Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage](#)

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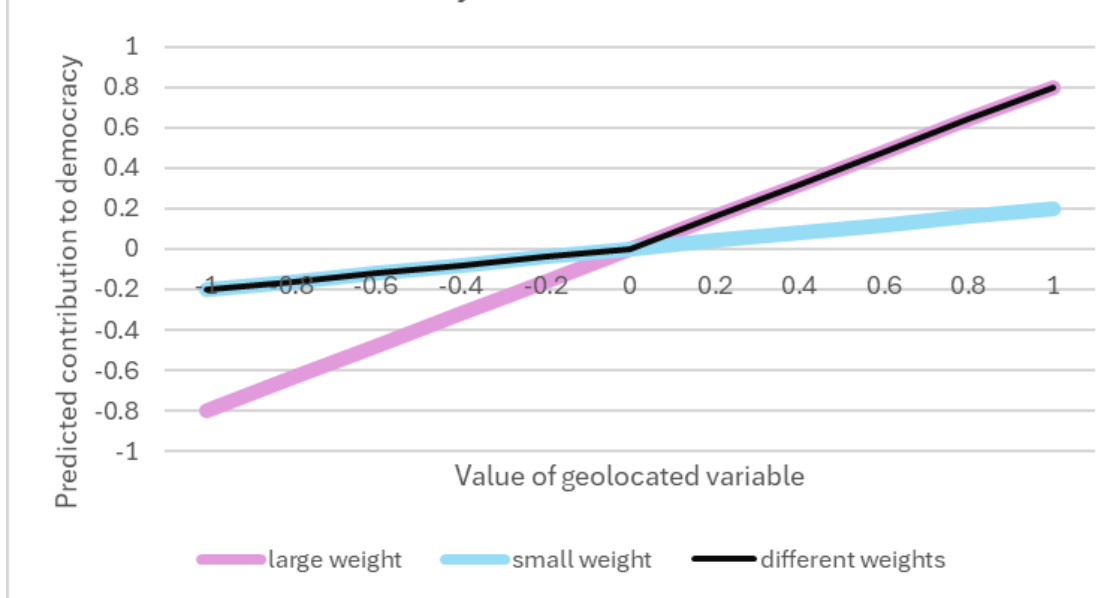
Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>
To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 12:30 AM

Well, now that I've given this more careful consideration and analysis, I still want to keep all the weights (emel and cscw for the criteria) positive. However, I'm noticing that other paired weights suffer from the same issue as NSEW: one half of each pair of poles (such as N and S, or urban and rural, or more development or less) often has a different weight than the other pole. Averaging them loses some relevant information; differencing them (subtracting the lower from the upper) would lose even more information, such as rendering that criterion irrelevant if the two poles have the same weights. The solution I proposed for NSEW -- keeping the weights separate for each of the four cardinal directions/poles -- deals with that situation well by allowing the contribution of each criterion to democracy be nonlinear, in the form of a line with a bend in it.

The chart below illustrates this nonlinear function. If we used a large weight (appropriate for large values of the geolocated/predictor variable), we'd get the lavender effect. If we used the small weight (appropriate for low values of the predictor), we'd get the blue effect. But we could use the low weight for the low values and the large weight for the large values, producing the black line. Does that make sense to you?

An asymmetric function



It would no more complicated to compute. Basically, we wouldn't combine high and low poles into dimensions. Instead, we'd keep the same positive weights for all criteria, but create two versions of each predictor variable: a "high" version that has the original values above the median and zeroes below the median, and a "low" version with the original values below the median and zeroes above the median. Then the effect for all of the criteria would be $\text{low weight} \times \text{low predictor} + \text{high weight} \times \text{high predictor}$ (and as before, ensuring that the "high" values correspond to pro-democracy predictions).

If you think this is worth pursuing, I would be happy to write some code for it on Sunday. Otherwise, we should probably just average the weights for each pole and combine the poles.

Michael Coppedge

Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center

University of Notre Dame

Notre Dame, IN 46556

(574) 631-7036

Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow

Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage

[Quoted text hidden]

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 12:51 AM

To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

If you think it will save more information, we can try the asymmetric function. You'll have to show me how to distinguish between high and low values of the geolocated variables. Would the 0-1 range change to a -1 to 1 range, with 0 in the middle? We will have the original script on hand so we can then compare the asymmetric function. Maybe when you have the script ready, you can share it with me over Zoom. I have been spinning my wheels with these two data sources for a while, and I can't count how many times I've adjusted the merging code, so I could use a re-orientation.

In response to your previous comment on the negative values, I had only been using the CDF function with geocoded data, not the V-Dem data. And up until the last version of our SNVDEM index, I had been taking the absolute values of all of the V-Dem criteria ratings. But because of the four directionality variables (as we discussed briefly Thursday after the snvdem meeting) I thought it made sense to leave the "raw" final ratings to interact with the two corresponding geolocated "paired" variables. (Some "raw" final ratings can be negative when, say, v2elsnmrfc registers 0.000 and v2elsnlfc registers 0.143--as in 2023 for criteria 16--because the calculation for EMEL is Elections More Free - Elections Less Free. Let's check in tomorrow. -Patrick

[Quoted text hidden]

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 8:09 AM

To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Sorry, you're right, the weights are not cdfs. But what I mean is that even if

$\text{v2elsnmrfc} - \text{v2elsnlfc}$ is negative, the $\text{abs}()$ of that will be positive.

However, I think I see now that your code for spatial_direction (or something close to that) will be really useful at the stage of saying whether each geocoded measure favors democracy or nondemocracy.

Sorry, I know it's frustrating to work with me when I'm not on top of everything you've done and I get "bright ideas" when we're already behind schedule.

Michael Coppedge

Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center

University of Notre Dame

Notre Dame, IN 46556

(574) 631-7036

[Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow](#)

[Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage](#)

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Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 11:46 AM

To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

It's fine, Michael. This project has a lot of complexity, and I've learned that changing one calculation--such as the cardinal directions--creates ripple effects up and down the pipeline. I think your idea of the asymmetric function won't affect calculation of the geolocated variables or their CDFs; what will change is the averaging of those values, something I have grown more uncomfortable with in recent weeks, probably for the reason you point out: we lose information that way. If you want to work on that function, let's do it. Meanwhile, I'm also happy to work with the index we've got for the time being. I need to rewrite the Colombia Illustration section, and then write the Validation exercises we discussed. -Patrick

[Quoted text hidden]

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 11:50 AM

To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Great.

I'm working on the data. I have completed calculating the weights for all criteria for both elections and civil liberties, adjusted for coders who said sn elections/civlibs don't vary subnationally, for all countries and years, and have merged them into a single df, which I'm attaching. (With some careful find-and-replace operations, it didn't take long.)

Now I'm going to subset it for Colombia 2000-2023, merge it with the geocoded data, and try out the asymmetric function.

Michael Coppedge

Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center

University of Notre Dame

Notre Dame, IN 46556

(574) 631-7036

[Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow](#)

[Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage](#)

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ELCLweights_wide.dta

6394K

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 3:23 PM

To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

When I'm comparing the predictor variables in CDF_averages_v1.rds, the variables look nearly random, like the attachment. Is that right? It looks different from variables we've seen in the past.

Michael Coppedge
Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center
University of Notre Dame
Notre Dame, IN 46556
(574) 631-7036
Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow
Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage

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Rplot.pdf
1499K

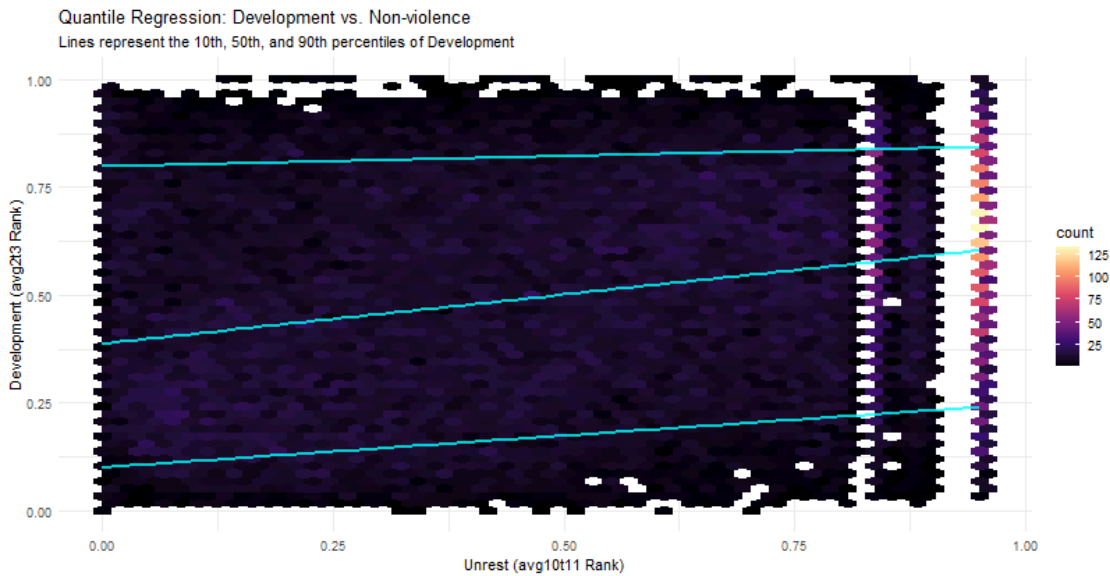
Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu> Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 5:01 PM
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

I think that makes sense. It's messy, especially with 27000 observations. But my understanding is that the CDF calculation essentially ranks municipalities within a 0-1 scale, per year. The vertical lines on the right would reflect the left-skewed nature of the violence data (as long as the avg10t11 variable has been "corrected" to align with pro-democratic expectations): most municipalities rank low on the violence index, even after the violence variables are logged and the CDF is calculated.

[Quoted text hidden]

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu> Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 5:16 PM
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

I asked Gemini to help with analyzing the results, so take this with a grain of salt. When I asked how best to measure correlations between variables calculated using CDF, it suggested running a quantile regression to see if the correlations differ across strata. It looks a little more convincing under this light.



"The Median ($\tau = 0.5$): The slope of **0.226** means that for the average municipality, as **Stability** increases (moving from left to right on your x-axis), **Development** also increases significantly. This suggests a "peace dividend" where safer areas tend to be more developed. **The Bottom 10% ($\tau = 0.1$):** In these less-developed areas, the slope of **0.147** indicates that even a small increase in stability is associated with an improvement in development ranking. **The Top 10% ($\tau = 0.9$):** The very flat slope of **0.047** shows that for the most highly developed areas, development level is almost completely independent of stability. These areas are likely the most resilient; they maintain high development rankings even if their stability scores are lower (further to the left on the x-axis)."

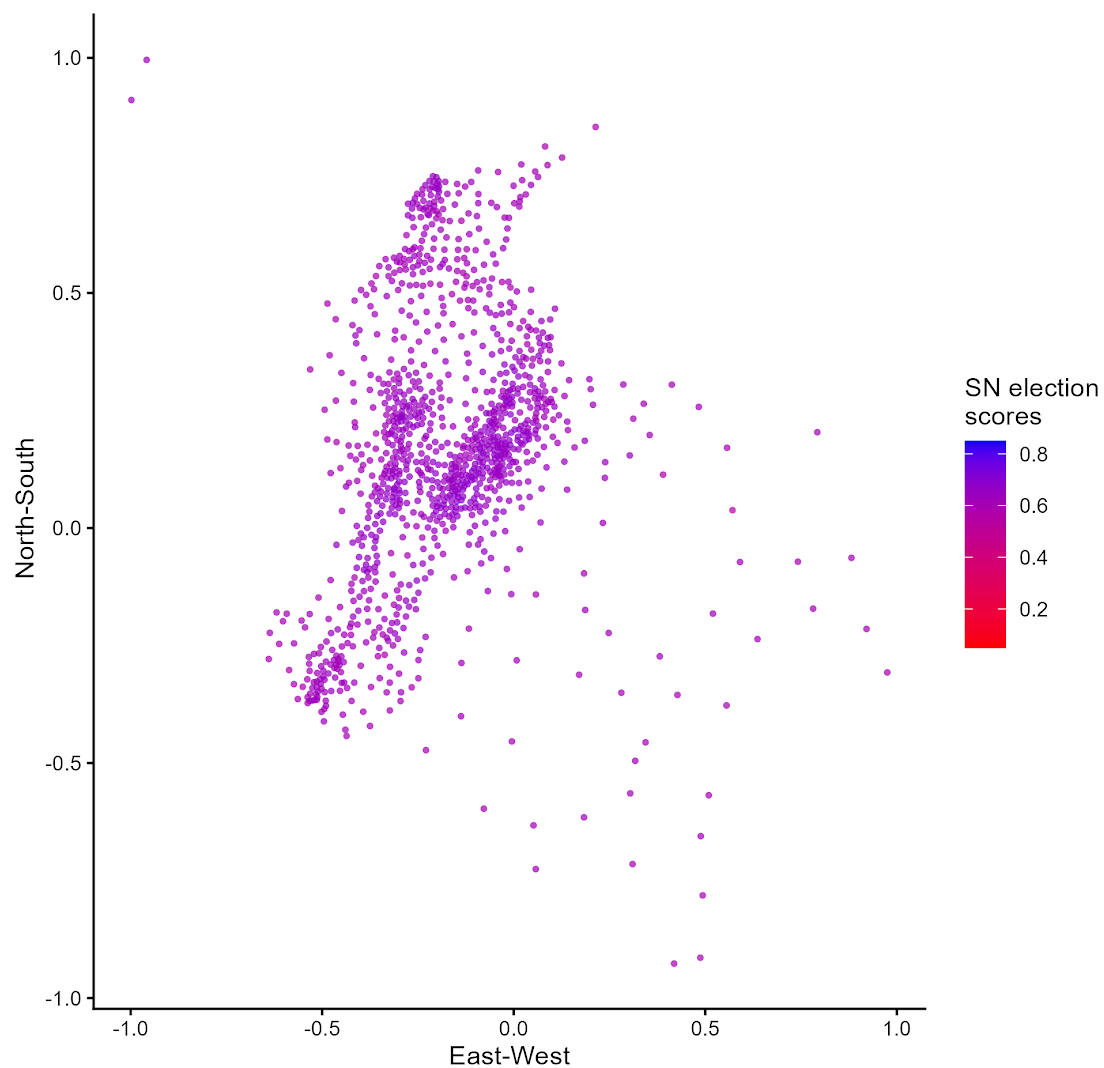
[Quoted text hidden]

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu> Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 5:22 PM

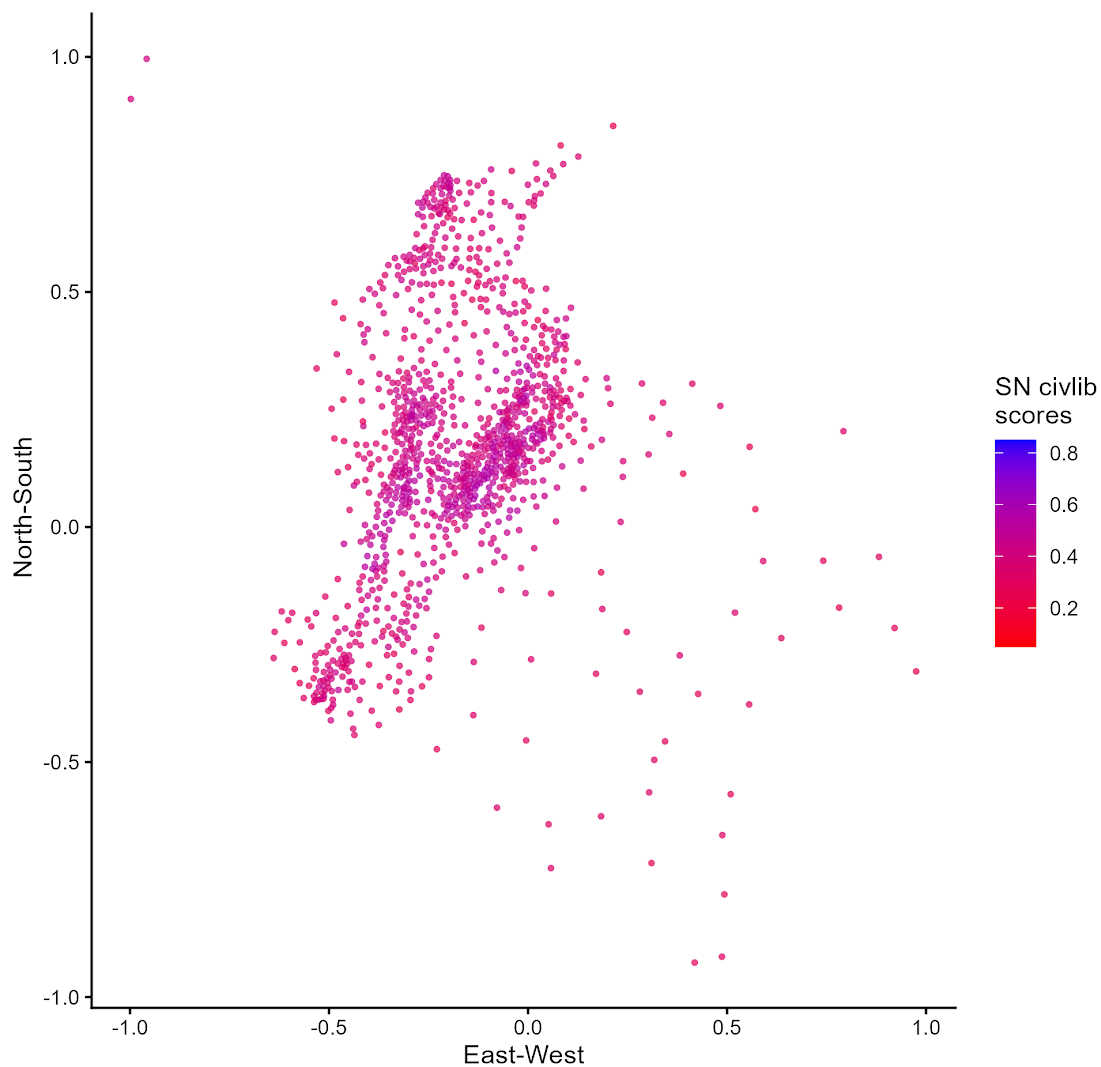
To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

OK, I went ahead with it and finished. I'm not sure I got the direction of ruling party strength and NSEW absolutely right, but it looks alright. Dataset and R script for the index creation are attached and some plots by mun coordinates are below.

Subnational election index, 2020



Subnational civil liberties index, 2020



Michael Coppedge

Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center

University of Notre Dame

Notre Dame, IN 46556

(574) 631-7036

[Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow](#)

[Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage](#)

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2 attachments



Indices_both.dta

14811K



wts&predictors.R

6K

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 5:48 PM

Thanks Michael. I'm reviewing the code now. If you want to discuss anything in particular, I'm happy to jump on a call. Just let me know. -Patrick

[Quoted text hidden]

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 6:36 PM

In your code, when you created the df "Indices_both", I noticed that the "sncivlib" variable was divided by electoral variables.

Constructing each index: FF elections

Indices_both <- Indices %>%

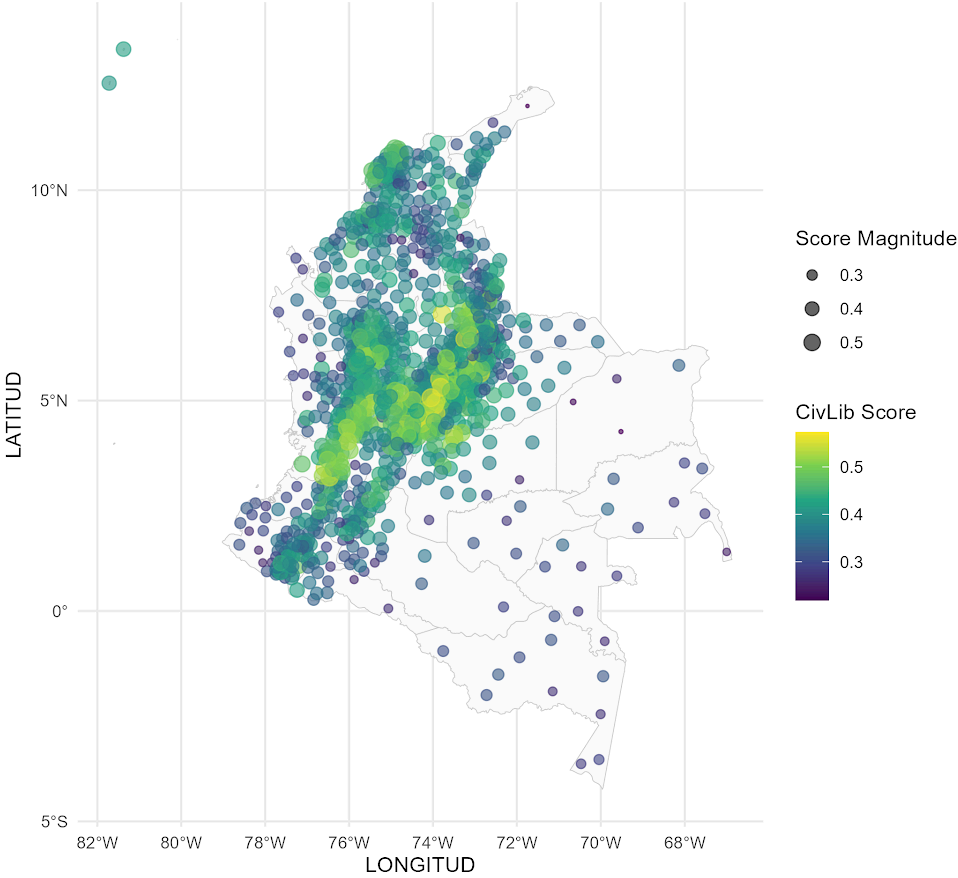
```
mutate(snelect = (avg0t1hi*el_Urban+avg0t1lo*el_Rural+
  avg10t11*wt_el_1011+
  avg12*el_Sparse_population+
  avg13*el_Remote+
  avg14*(1-el_Indigenous)+
  avg15t16hi*(1-el_Ruling_party_strong)+avg15t16lo*(1-el_Ruling_party_weak)+
  avg2t3hi*el_More_development+avg2t3lo*el_Less_development+
  avg4t5hi*(1-el_Inside_capital)+avg4t5lo*(1-el_Outside_capital)+
  avg6*el_North+avg7*el_South+avg8*el_West+avg9*el_East) /
  (el_Urban+el_Rural+
  wt_el_1011+
  el_Sparse_population+
  el_Remote+
  (1-el_Indigenous)+
  (1-el_Ruling_party_strong)+(1-el_Ruling_party_weak)+
  el_More_development+el_Less_development+
  (1-el_Inside_capital)+(1-el_Outside_capital)
  +el_North+el_South+el_West+el_East),
sncivlib = (avg0t1hi*cl_Urban+avg0t1lo*cl_Rural+
  avg10t11*wt_cl_1011+
  avg12*cl_Sparse_population+
  avg13*cl_Remote+
  avg14*(1-cl_Indigenous)+
  avg15t16hi*(1-cl_Ruling_party_strong)+avg15t16lo*(1-cl_Ruling_party_weak)+
  avg2t3hi*cl_More_development+avg2t3lo*cl_Less_development+
  avg4t5hi*(1-cl_Inside_capital)+avg4t5lo*(1-cl_Outside_capital)+
  avg6*cl_North+avg7*cl_South+avg8*cl_West+avg9*cl_East) /
```

```
(el_Urban+el_Rural+
  wt_el_1011+
  el_Sparse_population+
  el_Remote+
  (1-el_Indigenous)+
  (1-el_Ruling_party_strong)+
  (1-el_Ruling_party_weak)+
  el_More_development+
  el_Less_development+
  (1-el_Inside_capital)+
  (1-el_Outside_capital)+
  el_North+el_South+el_West+el_East))
```

So I adjusted this, which lowered the mean scores for civil liberties. Attached are some images of the result, and the new index (Indices_both2.rds).

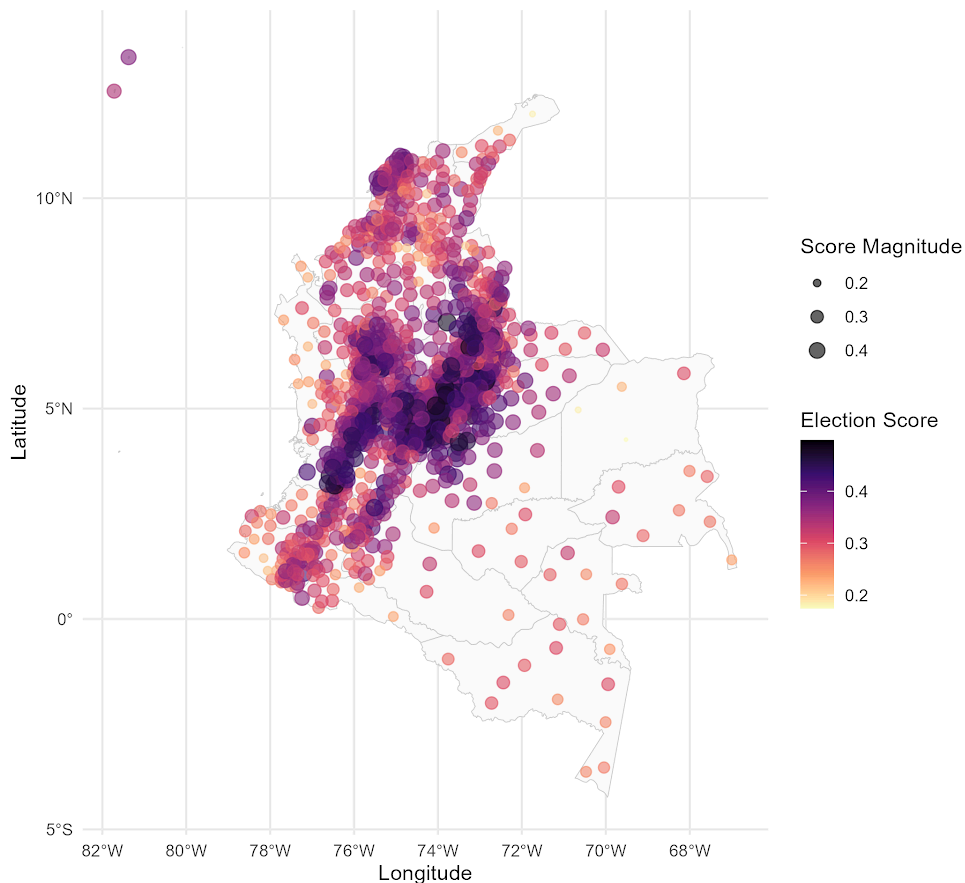
Subnational Civil Liberties Index, 2020

Bubble size represents Civil Liberties performance



Subnational Election Index, 2020

Larger bubbles indicate higher electoral performance



[Quoted text hidden]



Indices_both2.rds

15614K

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>
To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 9:00 PM

You're right! Great catch, and thanks for fixing that. Your maps look beautiful.

Michael Coppedge

Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center

University of Notre Dame

Notre Dame, IN 46556

(574) 631-7036

Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow

Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage

[Quoted text hidden]

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Sun, Jan 11, 2026 at 11:10 PM

Sorry to bother with this minutiae Michael, but I just noticed there are 3 NAs for weights variable `cl_Less_Development` in the dataset `weights_col` (the first filter you make in the `wtspredictors.R` script). They are for the years 2000-2002 (3 years). When combined with the predictors, this results in 3375 NAs for the `sncivlib` variable (1125 municipalities*3). I would re-do this variable if I could, but I don't have the script. Can you pass it to me? Or correct the `ELCLweights.dta` data frame yourself if it's easier. I could impute but that seems unnecessary. -Patrick

[Quoted text hidden]

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>
To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Mon, Jan 12, 2026 at 10:06 PM

I did that once with
`SNcol_by_year$CLrange_975_025[is.na(SNcol_by_year$CLrange_975_025)] <- 0.2443505`
to fill in with the average value of the lower bound, but it didn't seem to stick in the final version. Let's deal with this during revisions.
I have to prepare my course now.

Michael Coppedge
Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center
University of Notre Dame
Notre Dame, IN 46556
(574) 631-7036
[Political Science professor, Kellogg Institute fellow](#)
[Varieties of Democracy Co-PI. Individual webpage](#)

[Quoted text hidden]

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Mon, Jan 12, 2026 at 11:18 PM

Okay, sounds good! Have a good start to the semester. -Patrick
[Quoted text hidden]

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Thu, Jun 25, 2026 at 1:00 PM

Dear Michael, I am sharing the script I used to calculate the "final index," originally written by you and edited subsequently by me (thus, labeled v2). (See above our back and forth regarding small issues with the code.) But I don't believe I have access to the script you used to make the box plots (Figures 4-5 in our paper)--or if I have access, I can't find them. I wonder whether you can share that script with me to see whether you are using the "final index" data or not. -Patrick
[Quoted text hidden]

 **wtspredictors_v2.R**
13K

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Thu, Jun 25, 2026 at 1:09 PM

BTW: I will be on campus this afternoon if you want to meet and discuss this mismatch in person.
[Quoted text hidden]

Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>
To: Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>

Thu, Jun 25, 2026 at 1:29 PM

I'm not available this afternoon.

I'm attaching the script I used for the boxplots. It incorporates the national-level variables `CLSNmean`, `wtdCL_range`, `v2elffelr`, and `weighted_range` (calculated in some other script). It looks like the file you sent does not.
I'm also attaching the memo on this method and the three data sets the attached script calls for.

Michael Coppedge
Kellogg Institute, Hesburgh Center
University of Notre Dame
Notre Dame, IN 46556
(574) 631-7036

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4 attachments



Revised operational strategy_Jan2026.docx

597K



SNHPD.dta

1372K



snlsffHPD.dta

869K



COL_benchmarked.R

3K

Patrick McQuestion <pmcquest@nd.edu>
To: Michael Coppedge <coppedge.1@nd.edu>

Thu, Jun 25, 2026 at 1:30 PM

I think I know what happened: the images in the appendix are normalized scores, while the images in Figures 4-5 are not normalized.
Does that make sense?

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